In his letter to Khrushchev, on 27 October, Kennedy made clear that it was necessary 'for all work to cease on offensive missile bases in Cuba and for all weapons systems in Cuba capable of offensive use to be rendered inoperable, under effective United Nations arrangements.'[25] Khrushchev accepted and talks between the US and the Soviets soon began in New York. To consummate their tryst, however, Castro's blessing was needed. The problem was that Castro was incandescent at his (and Cuba's) treatment by Khrushchev. As seen in chapter seven, it took the diplomatic skills of Deputy Premier Mikoyan to win him over, though when he arrived in Havana, Fidel at first refused to see Anastas for ten days.

Unsurprisingly, Castro sought a broader settlement beyond the withdrawal of the Soviet forces and stipulated five conditions to normalise relations with Washington: first, an end to the economic blockade and other sanctions; second, a halt to subversive activities, the infiltration of arms and explosives by air and sea, the organisation of 'mercenary invasions', the infiltration of spies and saboteurs from the territory of the United States and its accomplices; third, an end to the 'pirate attacks' from bases in the US and Puerto Rico; fourth, a halt to all violations of Cuban air and naval space by US warships and planes; and fifth, withdrawal from Guantánamo Naval Base and the return of Cuban territory held by the United States.[26] Was this the basis for a realistic *modus vivendi?* The short answer is no. Certainly, for Washington, the Cuban commitment to supporting revolution abroad remained a red line.

Guantánamo remained (and remains) an historical anomaly, in some ways akin to West Berlin. One difference was that the US presence was a legacy of US imperialism – West Berlin was a legacy of a war fought by four allies in the destruction of Nazi Germany. Another difference was their military situations. West Berlin could not be defended militarily. Guantánamo could be defended (assuming it was not under attack from nuclear weapons). During the crisis, the suggestion that Guantánamo could be included in negotiations with Moscow with the possibility of giving up US rights was raised by McNamara (when it excited no great interest or reaction) and by Stevenson when it was leaked to the press (aided by JFK) to undermine the President's political rival. Moscow believed there was